

PRACTICAL TEST AUTOMATION WITH PLAYWRIGHT

Code Review Checklist for Test Automation

Review automation pull requests like a professional.

Introduction

Reviewing automation code well keeps the suite healthy and signals senior thinking. This checklist gives you a structured way to review (or self-review) test pull requests.

Review Checklist

- Does each test verify one clear behaviour?
- Are names descriptive (behaviour + expectation)?
- Are locators robust (role/label) rather than brittle?
- Are web-first assertions used (no manual sleeps)?
- Is data created and cleaned up; are tests independent?
- Is shared setup via fixtures, not duplication?
- Is the code readable and consistent with the project?
- Will it run reliably in CI?

Worked Example (review comment)

"This uses `waitForTimeout(2000)` before the assertion — can we switch to `expect(locator).toBeVisible()`? It will be faster and remove a likely source of flakiness."

Practical Exercise

Review a test (yours or a sample) against the checklist and write two constructive review comments.

Best Practices

- Be specific and constructive.
- Focus on reliability and readability.
- Praise good patterns, not just problems.

Common Mistakes

- Approving without running or reading carefully.
- Nitpicking style while missing flakiness.
- Vague comments the author cannot act on.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Being able to review automation thoughtfully is a senior skill. Even as a junior, leaving clear, constructive review comments quickly gets you noticed.